London in a Day

Thursday 12 to Saturday 14 November 2026

01 Wheels Up · Thursday, November 12 · the day that decides the trip · none of this happens in London

DO NOW

The UK ETA

gov.uk/eta, or the official UK ETA app · £20

> Apply only at gov.uk/eta or the official UK ETA app. Every other site charges more for the same thing and cannot make it faster. The app scans your passport and face with your phone, which b

READ

The weather you are flying into

London, mid November · Free

> Layers and a light waterproof shell, not a heavy coat. Long trousers, a jumper, closed shoes with grip because the pavements are wet. One warm layer for the walk along Euston Road. Nothing y

READ

Public transport only, read this once

Transport for London · Free

> Your entire day of travel is capped at £16.30. You touch zone 6 twice, Heathrow in and Heathrow out, so you will hit the zones 1 to 6 cap and everything in between is free after that.

NIGHT

The overnight flight

United States to London Heathrow · Free

> 11:40 in London is 03:40 at home. Your body will think the conference is happening in the middle of the night, because it is. Sleep on the plane even badly, and do not plan to work on it.

02 Two Rooms and a Museum · Friday, November 13 · the whole trip, in nine hours · SE1 at two, NW1 at five, WC1 at half six

11:40 AM

Land, and do one thing first

London Heathrow · Free

> **Palm Springs or LAX to London Heathrow. You are travelling alone, so nobody is holding a seat, watching a bag or waking you up. Aisle seat, and tell one person at home your flight number and your two event addresses before you board. · About 11 hours**

> If immigration runs long you lose conference time, not storage time. The bag still gets dropped. Walking into central London with a suitcase on this particular day is the one decision you ca

12:10 PM

Heathrow left luggage

Heathrow terminals, run by Excess Baggage Company · £15

> **Inside your arrivals terminal. Clear the eGates, collect your case, then follow signs for Baggage Storage or Left Luggage rather than heading straight for the trains. Ask at an information desk if you cannot see a sign, because the location is not published online. · 10 to 20 min**

> You land at 11:40 Friday and fly at 10:45 Saturday, which is just under 24 hours, so you are in the £15 band if you drop it promptly and collect it promptly. Book online at left-baggag

12:40 PM

Heathrow to Southwark

Elizabeth line to Bond Street, Jubilee line to Southwark · Free

> **1. From your terminal follow signs to the Elizabeth line (purple). Platforms are under T2&3, under T4 Arrivals and in the T5 basement.2. Take any eastbound train, 28 minutes, and get off at Bond Street.3. Follow signs to the Jubilee line (silver), southbound, platform direction Stratford.4. Ride four stops: Green Park, Westminster, Waterloo, Southwark. Get off at Southwark.5. Exit the station and you are a six minute walk from both lunch and the conference. · About 45 min**

> Skip Heathrow Express. It is £26 walk-up, it only reaches Paddington, and you would still have to change. The Elizabeth line costs half and goes where you are going.

13:20 PM

Lunch at The Africa Centre

Restaurant by Little Baobab, The Africa Centre, 66-68 Great Suffolk Street SE1 0BL · £20

> **From Southwark station. Leave by the main exit onto Blackfriars Road, turn right, then take the first left into Great Suffolk Street. The Africa Centre is on your left at number 66 to 68. If you overshoot you will hit Southwark Bridge Road. · 5 to 7 min**

> The Africa Centre's own homepage carries posts from its CEO saying the Centre has temporarily closed its doors. The posts are undated and their visit pages would not load when I checked, and

14:00 PM

Action on Male Suicide: London

Coin Street Neighbourhood Centre, 108 Stamford Street SE1 9NH · Free

> **From The Africa Centre. Head back up Great Suffolk Street to Blackfriars Road, turn left and walk north toward the river, then turn left into Stamford Street. Coin Street Neighbourhood Centre is at number 108, on the south side. All flat, all lit, no crossings that matter. · About 10 min**

> You will miss the research keynote and nothing can fix that. Dr Susie Bennett presents Why do men die by suicide? from 10:30 to 12:30 and you land at 11:40. Email her before you fly instead

16:15 PM

The ninety minute gap

South Bank to Euston Road · Free

> **1. From Coin Street walk west along Stamford Street, about 7 minutes, to Waterloo station.2. Follow signs to the Northern line (black), northbound, Charing Cross branch, platform direction Edgware or High Barnet.3. Ride seven stops: Embankment, Charing Cross, Leicester Square, Tottenham Court Road, Goodge Street, Warren Street, Euston.4. Leave Euston by the main entrance and walk west along Euston Road for about 5 minutes. Wellcome Collection is number 183, on your right, a big stone building you cannot miss. · About 25 min**

> If the afternoon session is gripping, stay. Wellcome then becomes a thirty minute stop instead of seventy five, and it is still worth it. The one thing that cannot move is 18:30 at Birkbeck.

16:40 PM

Wellcome Collection

183 Euston Road NW1 2BE · Free

> Go straight upstairs to Audrey Amiss: The Surviving Exhibitions. Do the permanent gallery only if time is left. The café runs to 18:00 and free lockers are on level 0, though nothing su

16:50 PM

Audrey Amiss, and why she is the reason

Wellcome Collection, 183 Euston Road NW1 2BE · Free

> At seven o'clock you sit down to hear a researcher describe interviews with 42 Mad activists about movements, memory and who gets to be an expert. You can spend the two hours before it looki

18:15 PM

Mad Movements

Birkbeck, University of London, Malet St WC1E 7HX · Free

From Wellcome Collection. Turn left out of the front doors, walk east along Euston Road to Gower Street, turn right and walk south for about 12 minutes past the UCL buildings. Take a left into Torrington Place, then a right into Malet Street. Birkbeck is the large building on your left. Flat the whole way and well lit. · About 15 min

Watch your email that morning. The room number at Birkbeck is only sent close to the date. Arriving at a university building at half six in the dark without a room number is a bad twenty min

21:00 PM

The hour after

Same room, no agenda · Free

Twelve hours of travel for two rooms is only worth it if you work the second one. You will have been awake for roughly twenty four hours by nine o'clock London time. Stay for thirty minutes

21:30 PM

Dinner with the hosts

Bloomsbury or Fitzrovia, walking distance · £35

London's two Michelin starred West African restaurants both shut before you can get to them. Akoko on Berners Street takes its last dinner booking at 20:45, fifteen minutes before your event

23:30 PM

Russell Square, and the night train

Russell Square station, Piccadilly line · £7

1. From Malet Street walk east along Montague Place, past the back of the British Museum, then north up Montague Street into Russell Square. The station is on the north east corner, about 5 minutes.2. Take the Piccadilly line (dark blue), westbound, platform direction Heathrow. Check the front of the train says Heathrow and not Rayners Lane or Uxbridge.3. Stay on it. It is roughly 17 stops and about 50 minutes, no changes.4. Get off at your terminal. Terminals 2&3 and Terminal 5 only overnight. · About 55 min door to door

Night Tube does not serve Terminal 4. It serves Terminals 2&3 and Terminal 5 only. Check which terminal you fly from before you get on. If it is T4, get off at T2&3 and transfer, or

03 Out Before the City Wakes · Saturday, November 14 · 10:45 to Palm Springs · this is not a day, it is a departure

00:30 AM

Overnight at Heathrow

London Heathrow · Free

I could not confirm from Heathrow's own site whether all terminals stay open overnight, or where there is seating. Their overnight page would not load. Check it yourself before Friday, becau

08:00 AM

Collect the bag

Heathrow luggage storage · Free

You dropped it around 12:10 Friday. Collecting by roughly 08:00 Saturday keeps you inside the 3 to 24 hour band at £15. Drift past midday Saturday and it becomes £27.50, though y

10:45 AM

Wheels up to Palm Springs

London Heathrow to Palm Springs · Free

Write the follow-ups before you land. Everyone you met will be fresh for about forty eight hours and then they will not be. One short message each, sent Sunday, beats a long one sent in Dece

04 If London Gets a Second Day · Everything the clock took · ready to go, in order · all free, all still there

- [ ] ANY DAY

The British Museum

Great Russell Street WC1B 3DG · Free

> Wheeled suitcases are not admitted, and a free timed ticket is advised rather than required. Their published Friday closing time was cut off mid-sentence on their own page when I checked, so

- [ ] ANY DAY

The British Library

96 Euston Road NW1 2DB · Free

> It is the best free place in this part of London to sit down and write for an hour, which on a day with no hotel room is worth more than another gallery.

- [ ] WED TO SAT

Bethlem Museum of the Mind

Bethlem Royal Hospital, Monks Orchard Road, Beckenham BR3 3BX · Free

> Eden Park station is about 30 minutes from London Bridge, then a 15 minute walk or the 356 bus to the Bethlem Royal Hospital stop. East Croydon is about 16 minutes from Victoria or London Br

- [ ] BOOK AHEAD

Chishuru

3 Great Titchfield Street, Fitzrovia W1W 8AX · £105

> Set menus only, not a la carte, and it closes at 21:30 on a Friday. Closed weekends and Wednesday lunch. Bookings open 60 days ahead through SevenRooms and go fast. Phone 020 7637 4748.

- [ ] BOOK AHEAD

Akoko

21 Berners Street, Fitzrovia W1T 3LP · Free

> Tasting menu only, and the last dinner booking is 20:45. Allow two and a half hours. They manage their own bookings: +44 20 7323 0593. Michelin lists it in the ££££ b

- [ ] BOOK AHEAD

Ikoyi

180 Strand, London WC2R 1EA · Free

> I could not verify Ikoyi's hours, prices or last seating from its own site. Everything here comes from a London guide, not the restaurant. Check directly before building anything around it.

- [ ] DEADLINE

Writing Madness, the anthology

madrights.anthology@gmail.com · Free

> You already have the submission. Finding Mental Freedom is four manuscripts of exactly this, written in exactly this voice. Pull 2,500 words out of one of them and send it. It is free, the d

- [ ] NOV 29

Commoning Across Otherwise

Bloc, ArtsOne ground floor, Queen Mary University, Mile End Road E1 4PA · Free

> You will be home. Register anyway. Registration needs host approval, which means a human reads your name, which means the network knows you exist. There is also a second session on Saturday

- [ ] NOV 19

Action on Male Suicide: Belfast

The MAC, 10 Exchange Street West, Belfast BT1 2NJ · Free